

LEGACY

DESIGN



Clockwise from left: Traditional design elements that are climate-appropriate architectural responses, are reinterpreted in modern design; Nikunj Agra. Salvaged, ornate red sandstone architectural pieces; Traditional brick and arch reimagined in modern architecture; Sheesh Mahal (Palace of Mirrors) at the Amer Fort complex as an example of historic regional craftsmanship where origin, material, and specialised artisan technique intersect.

In this context, one can speculate that an exceptional building, made entirely with local knowledge and materials, will benefit from the identity armour, besides wearing the GI sign as a mark of pride? Considering that there is an inextricable link between the Jaisalmer stone and the appearance of the over 200-years-old Patwaon Haveli in Jaisalmer (built by a wealthy merchant family that set the benchmark for luxury merchant architecture in the region), it is evident that a building should carry a sign defining its antecedents. Not only that, but by simply marking these buildings and giving them an identity, their stories, design narratives, preservation, restoration, reuse, and repurposing of the built environment becomes an easier task. Legacy, in this sense, is not merely about preservation—it is about legibility.

When a building carries a mark of origin, its story becomes accessible to the people who occupy it, pass by it, and inherit it. GI mapping, applied to the built environment, transforms anonymous structures into named carriers of cultural memory— making the legacy of a place tangible, quantifiable, and above all, readable.

For specific architectural elements, such as the Jaali, there are dozens of vernacular traditions that belong to their own particular part of the country. The finely hewn white marble screens around Agra and Jaipur are a remarkable contrast to the latticed wooden screens in

